

Awards

Ajai Chowdhry gets Padma Bhushan

Ajai Chowdhry, HCL founder and chairman of HCL Infosystems, has been awarded Padma Bhushan—one of the highest civilian recognitions in India.

Chowdhry took over the reins of HCL Infosystems as president and CEO in 1994. He was appointed the chairman of HCL Infosystems in November 1999. Under his stewardship, the company's turnover grew to Rs 122.21 billion from just Rs 4 billion in 1994. Employing over 7200 people, it has today emerged as the country's information-enabling powerhouse.

BEE label launched for notebooks

The Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) has launched a voluntary endorsement label for notebook computers and laptops. The BEE Star Ver 1 label will indicate that the product is among the most energy efficient models available in the Indian market.

The importance of endorsement labelling can be recognised from the fact that India's laptop computer market is growing very fast. The projection for 2011 is 42 per cent laptops and 58 per cent desktops, and combined sales of around 12 million units. The BEE labelling programme is expected to save energy from notebook computers. Desktop computers would be added to the programme in due course.

Canon launches 29 new products

Canon India has launched 29 new consumer digital imaging products in India. The product lineup includes an array of compact digital cameras, camcorders, lenses and all-in-one inkjet printers. The highlight of the launch is the introduction of seven entry-level digital camera variants in the sub-Rs 10,000 category.

"Canon's growth is now reaching an inflection point. While last year, we acquired one million customers, we are aiming to acquire two million customers in 2011 to reach a customer base of five million. Naturally, our technology propositions will continue to create better and richer experiences for consumers," said Alok Bharadwaj, senior vice president, Canon.

The announcement also shared



Canon PowerShot A2200

Canon India's future plans and strategies, to further capture the Indian market to realise the aim to generate revenues of \$1 billion by 2015. Canon is undertaking various innovative marketing strategies and plans to invest about Rs 1 billion for advertising this year.

Samsung eyes No. 1 position in Southwest Asia

Samsung Electronics recently organised the *Southwest Asia Regional Forum*

in New Delhi to celebrate a remarkable 60 per cent growth in its Southwest Asia operations. At the forum, the company outlined its regional strategy and 2011 product portfolio comprising innovations in Internet-connected TVs, consumer-inspired digital cameras and the latest mobile technology.

"This is a region of tremendous growth and potential for Samsung Electronics. We have the potential to reach No. 1 market share in numerous categories while strengthening our partner and channel relationships, particularly in a country like India where markets are maturing and the potential for growth is unlimited," said J.S. Shin, president of Samsung Electronics Southwest Asia.

PLG Power plans solar cell plant in Nashik

Mumbai-based PLG Power will invest about Rs 4100 million to establish a 120-megawatt solar cell manufacturing facility in Nashik. The company already has a 50MW solar photovoltaic modules manufacturing plant in Nashik, and had recently launched a 40MW solar power generation plant at Patan, Gujarat.

"We expect to start production by January next year," informed Punit K.



J.S. Shin, president of Samsung Electronics Southwest Asia, launching the 2011 product portfolio